

King loses to No. 3 Heights in 2 OTs

Tim Gebhardt
The Chronicle-Telegram

LORAIN — The state's third ranked Division I basketball team was on the ropes Saturday night at Admiral King.

But, just as an experienced, game heavyweight champion uses his savvy and guile in the late rounds of a fight, Cleveland Heights battled the odds and refused to be put away, winning 71-62 in two overtimes.

Heights, now 13-1, hasn't lost since its opening game while King lost for only the second time in 13 starts. The loss snapped a

BOYS BASKETBALL

10-game winning streak.

"I don't believe in moral victories," said John Rositano, the boss of the Admirals. "I think we're every bit equal to them as a basketball team. We just didn't get the breaks at the end.

"Cleveland Heights has had more experience in big games in the past, and I think that helped them. We'll learn from this."

King had the tempo to its liking. It was a possession by possession game, not the open court, run-and-gun style the Tigers feel

comfortable with.

Everything appeared in line for an upset.

"We had them under control," said Rositano. "We had the type of tempo we wanted. I thought we followed our game plan to a T. We had them frustrated. We played excellent defense."

The Admirals were sailing along to start the final period. Rashad Hannibal was getting open on the baseline for short jumpers as King built a 10-point cushion, 48-38, with 6:38 to play. Hannibal scored all but three of his game-high 29 to that point as the Tigers looked defeat right in

the face.

"We switched to a 1-3-1 (zone defense) to take that away," said Heights coach Jim Cappelletti. "We did a little bit of trapping out front. Just tried to give them a different look."

It worked. King's Doug Taylor was called for his fifth foul with 2:44 to play and Heights outscored the Admirals, 12-4, the final 6½ minutes to send the game to overtime.

King rebuilt a three-point lead and an opportunity for a pair of free throws with just 6.6 seconds left in the first extra session, but Tim Torrence missed the front

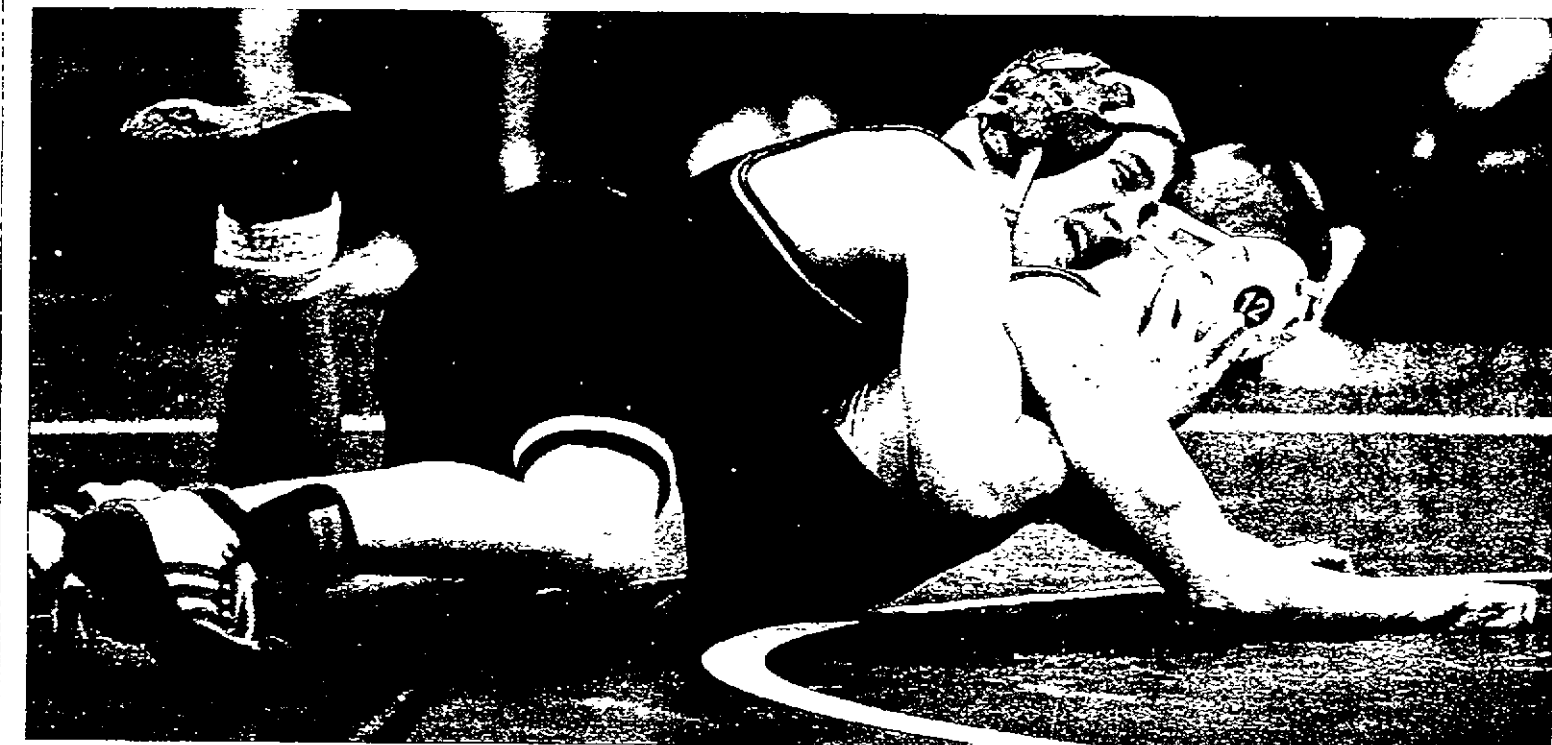
end of a one-and-one and Heights' high-scorer Jamaal Harris (25 points) launched a perfect three-pointer from the top of the circle as time expired to force a second four-minute extra period.

Heights fell behind again, 62-60, in the second overtime, but King went cold, missing its last nine attempts as the Tigers rolled away with the final nine-point spread.

"Again, a missed foul shot, and the guy (Harris) makes a great play and we go to double-overtime," said Rositano. "It's not easy coming back from an emotional setback like that. It

Cleveland Heights	G	F	T	Adm King	G	F	T
Harris	10	3	25	Harris	11	5	29
Russell	8	2	18	White	3	5	11
Hudson	3	6	12	Taylor	3	0	7
Dixon	4	0	8	Torrence	2	0	6
Lewis	1	4	6	Ranney	2	2	6
Miles	0	2	2	Amey	1	0	2
Blackson	0	0	0	Kille	1	0	1
Hutchinson	0	0	0				
Totals	25	17	71	Totals	22	13	62
Points by Quarters				Points by Quarters			
	1	2	3	4	OT	OT	T
Cleveland Heights	13	13	9	14	8	13	71
Adm King	12	19	13	6	4	—	62
Three-point goals: Cleveland Heights: Harris, 4; Russell, 2; White, 1; Taylor, 1; Torrence, 1; Ranney, 1; Miles, 0; Blackson, 0; Hutchinson, 0.							
Adm King: Harris, 2; Torrence, 2; Taylor, 1; Ranney, 1; Miles, 0; Blackson, 0; Hutchinson, 0.							

looks good for us and the next thing you know its tied and we have to go play four more minutes."



CHUCK HUMEL / CHRONICLE

PRESSURE POINT: Elyria Catholic's Scott Burnett is in control of the situation during his 8-5 win over Josh Frederick of Vermilion in a 112-pound match at Elyria Catholic Saturday.

Panthers go home and win two

Judie Asp
The Chronicle-Telegram

ELYRIA — There's no place like home — especially when you're only there one day a year.

In its only home meet of the season, Elyria Catholic improved to 3-0, besting Vermilion 50-18 and Lorain County Conference champion Firelands 42-33 in a tri-match Saturday. Vermilion got by Firelands 43-32.

"I think we wrestled well but it could have been even better," said Panther coach John McNulty.

"At one point, we were beating Firelands 33-6 but then everything happened and it ended up being close. It was still good to wrestle in our own place."

The Panthers received double wins from sophomore state place-winner Scott Burnett (112), sophomore Ed Cecil (119), senior state qualifier John Dunstan (123), sophomore Dustin Woods (135), two-time state contestant senior Steve Brush

WRESTLING

(145/152) and senior heavyweight Frank Gant (17-6).

Burnett remains unbeaten at 19-0 after a forfeit win and an 8-5 decision over Vermilion senior state placer Josh Frederick.

"Frederick only earned a takedown against Scott," McNulty said. "We kicked him out three times. Scott was in control of the match."

Frederick pinned his Firelands opponent.

Cecil (14-3) earned a 1-0 decision over former teammate Scott Hector, now wrestling for Vermilion. A second-period escape made the difference. Cecil also had a first period fall.

Dunstan looked sharp with a 15-4 major decision and a 49-second pin. Dunstan upped his season mark to 19-1.

Woods, a 15-6 sophomore, rolled to an 11-1 major decision and a 15-second pin.

"Dustin wrestled tough tonight," McNulty said. "He gets better every week."

Brush wrestled at 145 and 152 pounds Saturday night, receiving a forfeit and pinning at the 1:43 mark. The senior Panther standout earned his 20th victory with only one defeat.

Gant had a forfeit and a 10-5 win at 275 pounds, improving to 17-6.

Senior state qualifier Matt Kovach earned a pair of victories for Firelands at 103 pounds with a pin and a technical fall, improving to 19-2.

Falcon teammates Jason Carver (152), Chris Gargasz (160) and John Slack (171) were also double winners. Gargasz was involved in a 0-0 match with EC's Chris Conrad when an elbow injury forced Conrad to default.

"We're very young and inexperienced," said Firelands coach Jim Solomon. "We had four great years. I'm not down because it happens in all programs. I am very pleased with the effort we're getting."

Paul Trippett (140) and 189-pound Shamess Cassidy won a

pair for the Sailors. Trippett pinned at 1:44 and had a major decision. Cassidy won by margins of 6-2 and 9-5.

Elyria Catholic will participate in the Division III State Dual Meet Tournament next Sunday.

Firelands, now 4-6, hosts Avon Thursday in LCC action. Vermilion will entertain Elyria Saturday in an Erie Shore Conference match.

Elyria Catholic 50, Vermilion 18

103 — Robbin Dunn (V) pinned Drew Coen 2:32; 112 — Scott Burnett (EC) dec. Josh Frederick 8-2; 119 — Ed Cecil (EC) dec. Scott Hector 1-0; 125 — John Dunstan (EC) maj. dec. Ed Nading 15-4; 130 — Jason Gishell (V) dec. Paul Goss 2-0; 135 — Dustin Woods (EC) maj. dec. Mike German 11-1; 140 — Paul Trippett (V) pinned Chris Justin 1:44; 145 — Billy Kuhn (EC) forfeit.

152 — Steve Brush (EC) forfeit; 160 — Chris Gargasz (EC) pinned Rich Edmunds 43; 171 — Mike Wilson (EC) forfeit; 189 — Shamess Cassidy (V) dec. Jeff Knox 5-2; 215 — Damon Abraham (FC) forfeit; 275 — Frank Gant (EC) forfeit.

Elyria Catholic 42, Firelands 33

103 — Matt Kovach (F) pinned Drew Coen 1:05; 112 — Scott Burnett (EC) forfeit; 119 — Ed Cecil (EC) pinned Wes Marlowe 1:07; 125 — John Dunstan (EC) pinned Andy Neneith 48.

130 — Paul Goss (EC) dec. Bill Benham 9-7; 135 — Dustin Woods (FC) pinned Mike Grade 15; 140 — Chris Justin (EC) forfeit; 145 — Steve Brush (EC) pinned Dan Ferguson 1:43.

152 — Jason Carver (F) forfeit; 160 — Chris Gargasz (F) forfeit; 171 — John Slack (F) dec. Jeff Knox 7-5; 189 — Chad Bradley (F) forfeit; 215 — Frank Gant (F) pinned Damon Abraham 27; 275 — Frank Gant (EC) dec. Mike Thiaz 10-5.

BOYS BASKETBALL

Points by Quarters	1	2	3	4	T
Lake Ridge	13	16	19	9	57
Delaware	12	17	19	6	54
Three-point goals: Lake Ridge: Hurd 2, Sparrow, Delaware: Judy, Mount, Reed, Maurer					
JV: No JV					

Make free throws to win prizes

AVON LAKE — Youths ages 10 to 14 are invited to participate in a basketball free throw contest sponsored by the Knights of Columbus Father Ragan Council.

The annual event will run from 11 a.m. to 1:30 p.m. today at the St. Joseph Parish Gym, 32929 Lake Road.

Winners can advance to district competition, and from there, they can advance to regional and state championships. Participants in each age division have 25 shots. The youngster with the most baskets wins. A "shootout" will take place in case of a tie.

The Ohio Knights of Columbus championships will be March 16 in Columbus. For more information, call 933-5567.

Cleveland South rolls over Saints

LORAIN — Shauntee McCoy scored 19 points as Cleveland South cruised past Southview 65-52 in a non-conference game Saturday night.

Derrick Hill scored 20 to lead the Saints (1-12).

Cleveland South	G	F	T	Southview	G	F	T
McCoy	7	4	19	Wargo	2	0	4
JO Burge	1	0	2	Frances	2	0	2
Turnley	4	1	13	Maxwell	5	0	6
Suber	4	1	9	Sanford	1	0	2
Jacobs	4	2	10	Lane	2	0	5
Pattin	1	0	2	Stone	2	0	4
JE Burge	3	0	7	Hill	6	2	20
Barnes	1	0	2	Schull	1	1	3
				Ortiz	1	2	4
Totals	25	8	65	Totals	23	5	52
Points by Quarters				Points by Quarters			
	1	2	3	4		1	2
Cleveland South	18	15	19	13	—	11	15
Southview	14	12	12	14	—	13	17
Three-point goals: Cleveland South 3 (McCoy, Patrick, JE Burge); Southview 3 (Maxwell 2, Lane)							
Junior Varsity: Cleveland South 50-42							

Lake Ridge.....56

Delaware.....49

COLUMBUS — Tom Sparrow scored 19 points as the Royals won the consolation game of the Jaguar Invitational. Sparrow and Gene Legeza were named to the all-tournament team.

Paul Hurd netted 14 and John McMay added 13 for Lake Ridge (6-9).

Lake Ridge	G	F	T	Delaware	G	F	T
Legeza	1	1	3	Judry	2	2	7
Sedra	2	0	5	Mount	2	5	10
McMay	2	1	13	Koyal	1	0	2
Hurd	6	2	14	Reed	10	1	22
Sparrow	8	0	19	Maurer	2	1	8
Maczrak	1	0	2	Kean	0	2	2
Totals	24	4	56	Totals	17	11	48

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Dukes rock Raiders in fourth quarter

Robb Stolberg
The Chronicle-Telegram

WELLINGTON — It's tough to win a basketball game in just one quarter.

But Wellington did just that Saturday night. After leading Columbia by just one point after three quarters, the Dukes outscored the Raiders 22-5 in the fourth for a 65-47 win.

"It seems like every game we're having one miserable quarter," said Columbia coach Mickey Verdi.

It had been a tough week for Wellington, which dismissed two starters from the team for use of smokeless tobacco. But the Dukes proved they had put that behind them.

"The season is pretty much getting divided up into two halves," said Wellington coach Jerry Camp. The Dukes were 5-6 in the first half.

People are clearly stepping up to fill the shoes of the two players who left the team. Brian Wheeler sank three three-pointers and led the Dukes with 17 points.

Mike Mullins hauled in 18 rebounds, including 13 in the first half.

"There's nobody that wants the ball more than Mullins," said Camp.

Mullins also scored 16 points against the Raiders and was the Dukes' leading scorer the previous night, when Wellington battled back from a 21-1 deficit to finish just four points behind Avon.

"It takes some time for the kids to get used to playing together after the loss of two teammates," said Camp.

But clearly, after Friday's comeback and Saturday's win over Columbia, the Dukes are

BOYS BASKETBALL

Columbia	G	F	T	Wellington	G	F	T
Maly	0	0	0	Chappell	2	0	5
Skor	2	1	5	Wacker	4	4	13
Wade	5	0	11	Martin	0	2	2
Kelly	1	2	4	Mullins	8	0	16
Putzier	5	0	12	Mills	1	2	4
Bergner	2	0	4	Wheeler	7	0	17
Morton	2	0	11	Gallion	2	0	4
Simon	0	0	0	Moffitt	0	2	2
Ernell	0	0	0	Gardner	1	0	2
Totals	25	3	47	Totals	26	6	65
Points by Quarters				Points by Quarters			
	1	2	3	4		1	2
Columbia	11	18	15	5	—	11	15
Wellington	13	17	13	22	—	13	17
Three-point goals: Columbia: Chris Putzier 2, Brian Wheeler 3, Wes Chappell, Keith Wacker							
Junior Varsity: Wellington 41-33							

showing they are moving right along.

Columbia's Verdi pointed out his team's lack of offensive rebounds.

"They were quicker to the ball," he said. "I thought that was one of the keys to the game."

"We didn't take advantage of our size in terms of getting the ball inside. We were relying on our outside shot and weren't shooting the ball real well."

Columbia led four times and was down 43-42 going into the fourth. That's when the Raiders fell apart and the Dukes took control.

Camp had his players switch from a man-to-man to a zone defense because he saw his team getting tired and in foul trouble.

"That's the first time we ran that defense," said Camp.

It worked well as Wellington scored 10 points in the final quarter before Columbia sank a shot. The Dukes went on a 19-2 run before Barry Morton hit a three-pointer.

Morton and Bryon Wolfe each had 11 points for the Raiders while Chris Putzier led the team with 12.